Daily Content Intel

June 17, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, your high schooler comes home and says the whole team is on creatine, and you immediately think about their kidneys, right? I get this question from football and lacrosse parents constantly. So let's look at what the research actually says.

A systematic review came out this year in Cureus that pulled together the human studies on creatine monohydrate in adolescents and physically active kids. Five studies, including youth athletes, randomized trials, and a cohort that was followed for about seven years.

Here's what they found. Creatine was generally well tolerated, and there were no consistent safety signals in kidney function, liver enzymes, or cardiometabolic markers across the study periods. The kidney piece is the one parents worry about most, and serum creatinine and filtration rate stayed put.

Now I'll hedge this honestly. The adolescent-specific data is still kind of thin, so go slow, and keep the dose conservative. The doses they actually studied were small, around a tenth of a gram per kilogram of bodyweight a day, or a flat 2 to 10 grams a day.

So creatine monohydrate, real food first, smart dose, is one of the most studied and boring-in-a-good-way supplements we have. If your athlete is fueling and sleeping, it's a reasonable conversation to have. Talk to your doctor, then decide.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Your kid asked for creatine and you panicked. Here's what the research actually says.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, your high schooler comes home and says the whole team is on creatine, and you immediately think about their kidneys, right? I get this question from football and lacrosse parents constantly. So let's look at what the research actually says.

A systematic review came out this year in Cureus that pulled together the human studies on creatine monohydrate in adolescents and physically active kids. Five studies, including youth athletes, randomized trials, and a cohort that was followed for about seven years.

Here's what they found. Creatine was generally well tolerated, and there were no consistent safety signals in kidney function, liver enzymes, or cardiometabolic markers across the study periods. The kidney piece is the one parents worry about most, and serum creatinine and filtration rate stayed put.

Now I'll hedge this honestly. The adolescent-specific data is still kind of thin, so go slow, and keep the dose conservative. The doses they actually studied were small, around a tenth of a gram per kilogram of bodyweight a day, or a flat 2 to 10 grams a day.

So creatine monohydrate, real food first, smart dose, is one of the most studied and boring-in-a-good-way supplements we have. If your athlete is fueling and sleeping, it's a reasonable conversation to have. Talk to your doctor, then decide.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 "Is creatine safe for my teenager?"
- 0:08 Cureus systematic review, 2026
- 0:20 5 studies · youth athletes · RCTs + 7-year cohort

- 0:35 No safety signals: kidney, liver, cardiometabolic
- 0:50 Doses studied: ~0.1 g/kg/day or 2-10 g/day
- 1:05 Fuel + sleep first. Then talk to your doctor.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Every season a wave of high school athletes start creatine because the team does, and the parents text me in a panic about kidneys.

A 2026 systematic review in Cureus looked at the human studies on creatine monohydrate in adolescents and physically active kids. Across five studies, including youth athletes and a cohort followed about seven years, it was generally well tolerated with no consistent safety signals in kidney function, liver enzymes, or cardiometabolic markers. Serum creatinine and filtration rate held steady.

The honest caveat: adolescent-specific data is still thin, so the dose matters. What was studied was small, roughly 0.1 g/kg/day or a flat 2 to 10 g/day.

Creatine monohydrate is boring in the best way. Fuel and sleep come first. Then have the conversation with your doctor.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#creatine #youthathletes #footballparents #lacrosse #strengthandconditioning #sportsperformance #athletedevelopment #highschoolfootball #sportsnutrition #thresholdhp

Personalize this

- Which of your HS football or lacrosse athletes have asked you about creatine this offseason, and what did you actually tell their parents? Use that real exchange as the open.
- You program fueling and sleep before any supplement conversation. Name your own "food first" hierarchy at Threshold so the supplement lands as the last 5%, not the first move.
- Have you had an athlete or parent spooked by the kidney myth specifically? A 10-second story of walking one family

through it makes the kidney beat hit harder than the stat alone.

Screenshots:

- title | https://www.cureus.com/articles/471288-evaluating-the-safety-of-creatine-monohydrate-in-adolescents-a-systematic-review-of-renal-hepatic-and-cardiometabolic-outcomes | "Evaluating the Safety of Creatine Monohydrate in Adolescents: A Systematic Review of Renal, Hepatic, and Cardiometabolic Outcomes"
- physiology | https://www.cureus.com/articles/471288-evaluating-the-safety-of-creatine-monohydrate-in-adolescents-a-systematic-review-of-renal-hepatic-and-cardiometabolic-outcomes | "Across diverse populations, including youth athletes and adolescents with medical conditions, creatine supplementation was generally well tolerated, with no consistent short-term safety signals found in renal function, liver enzymes, or cardiometabolic risk markers within the study periods."

- actionable | https://www.cureus.com/articles/471288-evaluating-the-safety-of-creatine-monohydrate-in-adolescents-a-systematic-review-of-renal-hepatic-and-cardiometabolic-outcomes | "Weight-based regimens included approximately 0.1 g/kg/day, while fixed daily dosing ranged from 2 to 10 g/day."

Sources:

- https://www.cureus.com/articles/471288-evaluating-the-safety-of-creatine-monohydrate-in-adolescents-a-systematic-review-of-renal-hepatic-and-cardiometabolic-outcomes
- https://doi.org/10.7759/cureus.106808

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. If you're still testing one-rep maxes on your high school athletes every few weeks and programming off percentages, you're leaving strength on the table, and you're adding risk you don't need.

Here's the idea. Instead of locking the weight to a fixed percentage of a max that changes day to day, you watch how fast the bar moves and let the speed set the load. Good day, the bar flies, you add weight. Tired day after a Friday game, the bar drags, you back off. The athlete still trains hard, they just don't grind into a wall.

And there's research behind it. In a comparative study, the velocity group improved their squat by almost 28 percent versus about 9 percent for the percentage group, and bench went up about 14 percent versus about 9. A 2026 study found the same pattern in youth athletes, bigger gains in jump height, agility, and max strength.

So for my football and lacrosse athletes in season, I care way more about bar speed and how they're moving than about chasing a number on max day. The max will come. Train the speed, protect the athlete.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Stop maxing out your high schoolers. The bar speed tells you everything you need.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. If you're still testing one-rep maxes on your high school athletes every few weeks and programming off percentages, you're leaving strength on the table, and you're adding risk you don't need.

Here's the idea. Instead of locking the weight to a fixed percentage of a max that changes day to day, you watch how fast the bar moves and let the speed set the load. Good day, the bar flies, you add weight. Tired day after a Friday game, the bar drags, you back off. The athlete still trains hard, they just don't grind into a wall.

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So for my football and lacrosse athletes in season, I care way more about bar speed and how they're moving than about chasing a number on max day. The max will come. Train the speed, protect the athlete.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 "Stop maxing out your high schoolers"
- 0:10 Let the bar speed set the load

- 0:25 Fast bar → add weight · Slow bar → back off
- 0:40 Squat +28% (velocity) vs +9% (percentage)
- 0:52 2026: bigger gains in jump, agility, strength
- 1:05 Train the speed. Protect the athlete.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

If your high school program still tests a one-rep max every few weeks and builds the week off percentages, there's a better way to run it.

Velocity-based training lets bar speed set the load instead of a number that swings day to day. Bar moving fast, add weight. Bar dragging the Monday after a Friday game, back off. Same hard work, less grinding into the floor.

The evidence: in a comparative study the velocity group improved squat by almost 28% versus about 9% for the percentage group, with bench up about 14% versus 9%. A 2026 study in youth athletes found bigger gains in jump height, agility, and max strength too.

In season, I care more about how the bar moves than about a number on max day. The max will come. Train the speed, protect the athlete.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#velocitybasedtraining #strengthandconditioning #highschoolfootball #lacrosse #athletedevelopment #inseasontraining #sportsperformance #coaching #vbt #thresholdhp

Personalize this

- How do you actually run loading for your in-season football and lacrosse athletes, do you cue off bar speed, RPE, or a percentage chart? Show your real Monday-after-a-game adjustment.
- You use the Ian King speed-of-movement notation in your programming. Tie VBT to how you already prescribe speed of movement (3-1-1, etc.) so this isn't a new gadget, it's your system.

- Have you watched a HS coach burn an athlete out chasing a max, or seen a kid get hurt on a grindy last rep? One concrete story makes the "protect the athlete" line land.

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11089354/ | "Optimizing strength training protocols in young females: A comparative study of velocity-based and percentage-based training programs"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11089354/ | "VBT group and PBT group showed significant improvement in 1RM squat exercise (Δ% 27.87 and Δ% 8.98, respectively) and 1RM bench press (Δ% 14.47 and Δ% 8.65, respectively)"
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11089354/ | "Therefore, coaches and athletes should consider implementing VBT as a valuable tool to optimize strength and power development."

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11089354/
- https://link.springer.com/article/10.1186/s13102-026-01687-9

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Mike T. Nelson's "Coaching Leverage" (Coach Leverage = Physiology x Psychology; Protein first, Sleep last) from the 2026-06-17 newsletter, once paired with a real, screenshot-able protein or sleep paper rather than the sales email.
- Sprint exposure as hamstring injury prevention (reaching ≥95% of max sprint speed in training lowers strain risk) — strong teaching reel, needs an accessible non-paywalled primary (MDPI scoping review 403'd).
- Energy availability / under-fueling (RED-S) in high school athletes — couldn't surface a fresh 2026 primary this week; revisit.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest 2026-06-17 (~/Cowork/newsletter-digest/output/newsletter_digest_2026-06-17.pdf): thin day, 3 sources, 0 educational links. Dr. Mercola (promo/scare), Mike T. Nelson x2 (one pure promo, one good "Coaching Leverage" idea — Protein first, Sleep last — held as runner-up since the only source is a sales email).

- PubMed / web scan (athlete-biased): hamstring injury prevention via sprint exposure (MDPI scoping review, 403'd on fetch), adolescent sleep extension (no fresh primary), ACL/hamstring return-to-sport (no fresh accessible primary this week), creatine safety in adolescents (Cureus systematic review, April 2026 — verified, used for Draft A), velocity-based vs percentage-based resistance training (Heliyon comparative study verified + BMC Sports Science 2026 corroboration — used for Draft B), static stretching pre-sprint (mostly pre-2025, skipped).
- Cited-sources registry checked: 27 prior entries. Neither chosen URL appears in the last 90 days. Creatine cited 2026-06-16 was a different topic family (short-term loading, nutraingredients) and a different URL.